

E-mail #5: "Handling Objections"

If the prospect says YES, pull out your Advertising Order Form and start filling it out.

Don't stop unless or until he/she stops you with a question or an objection. It helps to have the "Category Index Listing" of companies available so you can classify the advertiser appropriately (attached, available for download from your HLSR website and for pick up at the next meeting on Tuesday, October 6).

It is important for you to remember that you can always call back for anything you need, except the signature. So, be sure to get the signature on the forms before you leave the prospect.

However, you should realize that in general people will not say yes on your first attempt. People generally want to seem smarter than that. So, in all likelihood they will ask you a question.

The key to success here is to answer the question and, once again, ask for the order.

Some people will "Object".

What is an objection? It is nothing more than a request for more information stated with some emotion.

Some people feel great pressure when asked to make a decision and this can elicit an emotional response. The key is to remain calm and listen, then paraphrase the prospect's objection in the form of a question. Once the prospect has agreed to the question, answer the question and ask for the order.

A question, or an objection, is an indication of interest and in this way is really your best friend in sales. So, don't fear an objection. Welcome it as an opportunity to answer a question and make a sale.

If your prospect's questions involve affordability of the ad, then flip to a half-page ad and show the prospect the ad while asking if he/she would like the half-page ad in color or black and white? If the prospect says color, proceed to complete the Advertisers Form.

This "either / or" close is called the fatal alternative close. By answering either choice "a" or choice "b", the prospect is still buying.

BUT, what if your prospect says "Let me think about it"? Then you are actually hearing him or her say "tell me more."

Standard objections take the following forms:

Delay: "I want to think about it."

Transfer: "I need to talk to my husband/wife/boss, etc."

Excuse: "We really can't afford it now."

Negate: "I don't think I'm interested right now."

Each one of these is a request for additional information. Before the prospect will listen to you, you have to listen to the prospect and prepare him/her for the additional information.

So here is how you do it:

"Mr. *Prospect*, I thought you might say that. I certainly would not expect you to make a decision on the spot. Would it be okay if I asked just a few quick questions?"

This statement relieves the pressure the prospect might be feeling by letting him/her off the hook for a decision. The prospect will say yes and then you can say...

"Do you have a budget for advertising? Do you have a budget for charitable gifts?"

If yes to both,

"If you were to contribute to the Rodeo, what budget item would it fall under?"

"Do you feel that the HLSR is a worthwhile charity?"

"Would you be interested in hearing about the other ways that you might support HLSR?"

Now you have prepared the prospect for additional information. Pull out your FAQ / Fact Card and review some of the information with the prospect. Then close again by asking the closing question:

"Would you rather make a contribution or purchase an ad?"

Once again... wait for the answer.

Just remember to always ask for action when you are ready to stop talking. That is it - fairly simple and easy.

If the prospect won't act, don't antagonize. Just thank the prospect for his/her time and move on to the next prospect. But I think you will be surprised how well these techniques can work to move the prospect to a YES!